

HackOps '26

Participants' Handbook - Event Flow & Rules

Every participant needs to compulsorily attend OE Lecture

Organised by DJS Infomatrix | Wednesday, 9th September 2026

1. Overview

HackOps '26 is a single-day, 5-hour build sprint. Teams pick one of five problem statements spanning ML, CV, DL, SDE, AI, finance, and applied real-world domains, and ship a working prototype within the window.

Venue: L5, AI Lab, CR31.

This is an internal event. There is no prize pool and no external judging panel. Evaluation is done against a rubric prepared by the organising team. The focus is on building and on the technical review that follows.

2. Registration and Team Rules

- College ID card is mandatory for entry - every participant must wear it visibly through the event.
- Report at 9:00 AM sharp to CR31. Attendance and team registration will be marked by Swayam, our Admin Sir.
- No team will be accepted after 9:15 AM under any circumstance.
- Teams must stick to the classroom/lab allotment provided to them. Do not relocate without organiser approval.
- Teams must not share their work with other teams at any point during the hackathon.

3. Integrity, Plagiarism, and Disqualification

HackOps '26 has zero tolerance for plagiarism, cheating, or copying existing work. Read this section carefully before the event begins.

Code origin

- No pre-built repositories, no pre-built solutions, and no prior project work of any kind. Every line of code that forms your submission must be written from scratch during the 5-hour window - starting at 10:00 AM and ending at 3:00 PM.
- Existing work cannot be submitted or adapted, whether it is your own past project, a teammate's earlier work, or anything sourced from elsewhere - GitHub, open-source repositories, tutorials, or otherwise.
- Boilerplate scaffolding generated fresh during the event (e.g. a framework's default starter template) is acceptable; carrying over a project you had already built before the event, even partially, is not.
- If your idea resembles a project you have built before, you must still rebuild it from zero within the window - no copy-pasting old code, no reusing old repositories.

What is allowed

- Third-party technologies, libraries, frameworks, APIs, SDKs, pre-trained models, and hosted services may be freely integrated. Building on top of existing tooling is expected and encouraged - this is normal software development.
- All coding tools are permitted without restriction, including AI assistants such as Copilot, Cursor, and Claude Code. Use whatever gets you to a working build faster - the constraint is on reusing your own or others' pre-existing solutions, not on the tools you use to write new code.
- You may use datasets, documentation, and reference material to inform your build, as long as the resulting code and application logic is your own original work created within the event window.

Automated originality scan

- Every submission is scanned directly by an AI agent the moment it is submitted. The agent checks for pre-existing work, reused solutions, and commit patterns inconsistent with a genuine 5-hour build.
- Initialise a fresh repository at 10 AM and commit incrementally throughout. All participants have to maintain a GitHub repository. A single large commit near the deadline is a flag against you.
- Commit history must remain visible and must not be squashed or rewritten before submission.

Grounds for immediate disqualification

- Submitting another team's work, or presenting a prior project as new.
- Any form of cheating, plagiarism, or copying an existing solution - detected automatically or otherwise.
- Sharing your build with another team, or using a build shared by another team.
- Ill talking or making disparaging remarks about other teams, mentors, or organisers.
- Mistreating or being disrespectful toward fellow participants, volunteers, or mentors.
- Disrespecting judges or mentors during the mentoring round or evaluation.
- Creating a fuss, causing disruption, or behaving in a manner that disrupts the event for others.

Repositories are locked at 3:00 PM. Commits made after this timestamp are not evaluated, regardless of reason.

4. Instructions for the Hackathon

9:00 AM - Reporting

Report to CR31 and mark your team's attendance with our admin, Swayam. This is mandatory and is your team's official check-in - no team is considered registered for the day without it and neither will attendance be provided by the department.

9:30 AM - Problem Statement Release

Problem statements will be released on the WhatsApp group. You get exactly 30 minutes to read through all five statements and decide, as a team, which one you will build. No extra time will be given beyond this window, and a form will be floated for problem statement selection immediately after.

This 30-minute window is for your team alone. Approaching mentors or organisers for advice on which problem statement to pick, or how to interpret one, during this round will be noted and will count against your team - it is read as an inability to independently understand a problem and make a decision, and will lower your evaluation. Read with full focus, discuss internally, and choose decisively.

"A wise decision made in haste is rare; a wise decision made with attention is repeatable."

10:00 AM - Coding Round Begins

The coding round starts sharp at 10:00 AM. From this point, no doubts or clarifications can be raised with mentors or organisers - this time is entirely yours to build. It is strongly suggested that teams spend the first 30-45 minutes on ideation, dividing roles clearly, before diving into development. Build harmoniously and avoid wasting time - time, once spent, cannot be earned back.

1:00 PM - Mentoring Round

Allotted mentors will visit your table to review progress. Each team gets a maximum of 5 minutes to present their idea and current build, followed by 7 minutes of Q&A with the mentor. Come prepared with specific, well-formed questions about architecture, approach, or blockers - vague questions such as "what should we build next?" or "what can I do?" will not be entertained.

The advice given to you in this round will be checked against your final submission at the evaluation stage. If a team is significantly behind schedule with little to no visible progress, this will be raised as a concern during evaluation, regardless of the advice received.

3:00 PM - Coding Ends, Submission Opens

The coding round ends at 3:00 PM sharp. A submission link will be floated immediately after. Every team must submit their **GitHub repository link** along with **photos** or a **video recording** of the working application. Respect the submission timeline strictly - anything not pushed to the repository by 3:00 PM will not be picked up. Brownie points are awarded for teams that also submit a deployed live link, a technical document, or a presentation deck.

Recommendation: record your demo video at 2:30 PM, not 2:59 PM. Teams lose submissions to last-minute uploads far more often than they lose marks to imperfect code. Plan your recording window in advance and do not leave it for the final minutes.

5. Evaluation (3:00 PM – 4:30 PM)

Mentor pairs will visit every team at their desk. Each team gets 8 minutes to pitch their application - walk the mentors through what you built and what you want to showcase. This is followed by 5 minutes of Q&A, where mentors may ask anything from why a particular feature was built, to the underlying logic and code decisions. Be prepared to defend your build in detail.

The specific evaluation rules and guidelines the mentor pairs work from will be revealed separately.

Broad areas assessed

- Functionality - does the build run, and does it do what it claims
- Technical depth and correctness of approach
- Coverage of the deliverables listed in the chosen problem statement
- Explainability and evidence, where the problem statement demands it
- Interface and demo quality
- Knowledge of the participant
- Respect given to the deadlines and fairness of approach
- Originality of the build within the 5-hour window

Stay at your desk through the evaluation window with the project running locally and your demo ready. Technical Document or a Deployed Link if submitted will be given higher weightage than a GitHub repository though it is completely optional.

6. Schedule - 9th September 2026

Time	Activity
9:00 AM	Reporting. Participants gather in CR31 for attendance
9:30 AM	Keynote and problem statement release
9:30 – 10:00 AM	Problem statement selection and ideation
10:00 AM	The coding round begins (sharp). Teams move to allotted classrooms/labs
1:00 PM	Mentoring round
3:00 PM	Coding ends. Hard stop, repositories locked
3:00 – 4:30 PM	Evaluation. Mentor pairs visit each desk
4:30 PM	Post-Hackathon Meet and Discussion

7. Post-Hackathon Meet and Discussion

4:30 PM - Post-Hackathon Meet and Discussion.

All the best!

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